

Subject Description Form

Subject Code	APSS2S04																	
Subject Title	Understanding Children in Poverty in Hong Kong																	
Credit Value	3																	
Level	2																	
GUR Requirements Intended to Fulfill	This subject intends to fulfill the following requirement(s) : ☐ Healthy Lifestyle ☐ AI and Data Analytics (AIDA) ☐ Innovation and Entrepreneurship (IE) ☐ Languages and Communication Requirement (LCR) ☐ Leadership Education and Development (LEAD) ☒ Service-Learning ☐ Cluster-Area Requirement (CAR) ☐ Human Nature, Relations and Development [CAR A] ☐ Science, Technology and Environment [CAR D] ☐ Chinese History and Culture [CAR M] ☐ Cultures, Organizations, Societies and Globalization [CAR N] ☐ China-Study Requirement ☐ Yes or ☐ No ☐ Writing and Reading Requirements ☐ English or ☐ Chinese																	
Pre-requisite / Co-requisite/ Exclusion	Nil																	
Assessment Methods	<table border="1" style="width: 100%; border-collapse: collapse; margin-bottom: 10px;"> <tr> <th style="width: 50%;">100% Continuous Assessment</th><th style="width: 25%;">Individual Assessment</th><th style="width: 25%;">Group Assessment</th></tr> <tr> <td>1. Performance in community service learning project</td><td style="text-align: center;">20%</td><td style="text-align: center;">20%</td></tr> <tr> <td>2. Reflection Journals</td><td style="text-align: center;">30%</td><td style="text-align: center;">--</td></tr> <tr> <td>3. Participation in class and seminar presentations</td><td style="text-align: center;">10%</td><td style="text-align: center;">20%</td></tr> <tr> <td>4. Service Learning e-learning module</td><td style="text-align: center;">Pass/Fail</td><td style="text-align: center;">--</td></tr> </table> - The grade is calculated according to the percentage assigned; - The completion and submission of all component assignments are required for passing the subject; and - Student must pass all component(s) if he/she is to pass the subject - The e-learning module is a compulsory element			100% Continuous Assessment	Individual Assessment	Group Assessment	1. Performance in community service learning project	20%	20%	2. Reflection Journals	30%	--	3. Participation in class and seminar presentations	10%	20%	4. Service Learning e-learning module	Pass/Fail	--
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Objectives	The objectives of the subject are to: a) foster students' understanding on poverty issues and to encourage them to develop interpersonal communication skills through participating in community services; b) enhance students' understanding of the discrimination, disadvantages and structured inequalities faced by poor people in Hong Kong, especially on their social identities, self-perception and personal aspiration; c) understand the present social service provisions, identify their inadequacies, and make recommendations for policy and services change if needed; d) support poor families children facing learning difficulties and personal and social integration problems through direct engagement and volunteer activities.
Intended Learning Outcomes	Upon completion of the subject, students will be able to: a) master application of knowledge, theories and skills to deal with complex issues as in the case of children poverty in the service setting; b) reflect on their roles and responsibilities as a fellow citizen with professional trainings; c) develop empathy for poor people in need and sense of social responsibility; d) understand issues and social theories related to the poverty in Hong Kong, and demonstrate ability in investigating the root causes and the effectiveness of the encountering measures in poverty alleviation.
Subject Synopsis/ Indicative Syllabus	The subject is designed to integrate knowledge with practices through lectures and community service and social learning from serving poverty groups disadvantaged by their socio-economic status. 1. Service Learning and University Education 2. Poverty and Intergenerational poverty in Hong Kong and the world 3. Poverty Alleviation and Income Maintenance Measures in HK 4. Cultural Sensitivity and Engaging with Poverty 5. Program Planning and Engagement Skills for Service Learning 6. Critical reflections • Experiencing marginalization and intergenerational poverty in a fast growing city • Visions of equality and social justice • Learning from the poor families

Teaching/Learning Methodology	This subject aims to enable students to learn more about the poverty issues through community service learning. Before students are assigned to their community service learning project, they are expected to attend a series of lectures focusing on providing them with a critical understanding of poverty problems in general and the poor children's difficulties in particular in the Hong Kong and the Globe context. They will also be given opportunities to meet representatives from the partnering community organizations to find out in greater details the work and community services they are providing before they are engaged in their service learning project. Before the community service, students will have to complete 10 hours of Service Learning e-learning module "Learn to Serve, Serve to Learn: Introduction to Service-Learning" delivered by the Service Learning and Leadership Office at PolyU. It consists of reading, exercises and assessments that are designed to introduce students to the basic concept and practice of service learning. Students are required to successfully complete the e-learning module in order to pass the subject. During their community service, reflective seminars and preparatory workshops will be organized so that they can share with the NGO colleagues and school tutors for their learning experiences and progress, and discuss their service delivery as well as learning strategies when necessary. The three broad aspects in service learning, including the attitude change, skills enhancement and knowledge consolidation will be emphasized throughout the service-learning experience in serving children living in the poor families. The concrete experiences learnt and the practical help for the children living in the poor families can include (but not limited to) the following: 1) making home visit to the attached poor family 2) servicing the poor children both individually and in group 3) co-organizing recreational/community-activity for the selected poor families 4) co-organizing social educational event for the poor families Through attaching to a poor family with children, the students can first rethink what poverty is and its impact on individuals, family and community. The service learning project in the 2nd stage (including the home visit, tutoring, recreational activity and social educational event) can help transform students' understanding on the needs of the children living in the poor families to deeper reflection on the importance of social equality and justice. In sum, the service learning tasks added together will facilitate the students to assess (home visit), engage (tutoring), serve (recreational/community-activity) and organize (the social educational event) the target group both internally for the community and externally for the general public, and will provide the children in need some substantial help and effort for social changes in a mutual, respectful and engaged manner.
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Assessment Methods in Alignment with Intended Learning Outcomes	Specific assessment methods/tasks	% weighting	Intended subject learning outcomes to be assessed (Please tick as appropriate)			
			a	b	c	d
	1. Performance in community service learning project (team work, awareness/attitude change, skills and knowledge consolidation)	40%	✓	✓	✓	
2. Reflection Journals (appreciation of relationships between diversities and inequality, understanding of civic responsibility and social justice as well as the evaluation of different poverty alleviation strategies)	30%	✓	✓	✓		
3. Participation in classes and seminar-presentations (communicating actively and reflective in service learning)	30%		✓	✓	✓	
4. Service Learning e-learning module	Pass/Fail	✓	✓			
Total	100 %					
Explanation of the appropriateness of the assessment methods in assessing the intended learning outcomes: Students are expected to complete 40 hours of community service learning. They will be monitored and supervised by subject lecturers and representatives of partnering organizations in planning and delivering the services. On-going feedback will be given to the students to improve their performance and learning. Their skills in planning, effectiveness in implementing activities, ability in communication and problems solving, as well as their commitments in service learning will be carefully considered on the basis of their performance assessed not only by instructors, but also by staff from the community service organization and feedback from service recipients. In addition, students are required to submit two pieces of reflective reports at different intervals throughout the service-learning project to indicate how they interpret their service-learning experience, particularly in terms of their critical appreciation of the relations between class and social inequality, as well as their understanding of civic responsibility and social justice. One mid term and one final group report session will be required at the middle and the end of the subject too. One mid term and one final group report session will be conducted at the middle and the end of the subject too. Students will altogether participate in						

	exploratory lectures, preparatory workshops, reflective seminars and mid-term/final presentation to account for their learning, progress, performance and commitment to service-learning.	
Student Study Effort Expected	Class contact:	
	▪ Lectures and preparatory workshops	15 Hrs.
	▪ Reflective mid-term and final presentation	6 Hrs.
	Other student study effort:	
	▪ 4. Service Learning e-learning module	10 Hrs.
	▪ Community service and exposure in old urban areas e.g. Sham Shui Po or new towns e.g. Tin Shui Wai	40 Hrs.
	▪ Preparation for mid-term and final presentations	26 Hrs.
	▪ Self-directed study for reflective journals	24 Hrs.
	Total student study effort	121 Hrs.
Reading List and References	References: Cheung, C.K., & Chou, K.L. (2018). Measuring Child Poverty in Hong Kong: Sensitivity to the Choice of Equivalence Scale. <i>Social Indicators Research</i>, 139(3), 909–921 Cheung, C.K., & Chou, K.L. (2018). Child Poverty Among Hong Kong Ethnic Minorities. <i>Social Indicators Research</i>, 137(1), 93–112 Cho, E. Y.N., & Wong, V. C. W. (2022). Children’s Lived Experiences in Poverty in Hong Kong as a High-Income Asian Society. <i>International Journal of Environmental Research and Public Health</i>, 19(10), 6190 Cheung, C. K. (2015). Child Poverty in Hong Kong Single-Parent Families, <i>Child Indicator Research</i>, 8, 517-526 Cheung, K., Chan, W., Chou, K., & Lau, M. (2018). Evaluating the Effectiveness and Efficiency of Hong Kong Welfare Programmes in Reducing Child Poverty. <i>Children & Society</i>, 32(6), 481-491 Chou, K. L., Cheung C, K. (2016). Working Poor in Hong Kong, <i>Social Indicator Research</i>, 129, 317-335 Commissioner on Poverty. (2020). <i>Report of the Commission on Poverty</i>. HK: HK Government Fernandez, E., Zeira, A., Vecchiato, T., & Canali, C. (2015). <i>Theoretical and Empirical Insights into Child and Family Poverty: Cross National Perspectives</i>. Springer International Publishing Goodstadt, L. F. (2013). <i>Poverty in the Midst of Affluence: How Hong Kong mismanaged its prosperity</i>. HK: Hong Kong University Press.	

	Guo, Y., Chang, S.-S., Sha, F., & Yip, P. S. F. (2018). Poverty concentration in an affluent city: Geographic variation and correlates of neighborhood poverty rates in Hong Kong. <i>PloS One</i>, 13(2): 1-17 Ho, K. Y., Li, W. H. C., & Chan, S. S. C. (2015). The Effect of Poverty and Income Disparity on the Psychological Well-Being of Hong Kong Children. <i>Public Health Nursing</i>, 32(3), 212–221 Khiatani, P. V., She, M. H. C., & Chui, W. H. (2021). Child Poverty in an Affluent City: Trends and Risk Factors in Hong Kong Between 2011 and 2016. <i>Child Indicators Research</i>, 14(6), 2325–2346 Morgan, R. (Ed.). (2016). <i>The global child poverty challenge: in search of solutions</i>. Practical Action Publishing Mok, K. H. (2015). Enhancing Global Competitiveness and Human Capital Management: Does Education Help reduce inequality and poverty in Hong Kong? <i>China Review</i>, 15:2, 119-146 Lau, M. (2015). Poverty in Hong Kong, <i>China Review</i>, 15: 2, 23-58 Lau, M., & Gordon, D. (2017). <i>Poverty in a Rich Society: The Case of Hong Kong</i>. The Chinese University Lewis, O., & La, F. O. (1959). <i>Five Families; Mexican Case Studies in the culture of poverty</i>. New York: Basic Books. Peng, C., Fang, L., Wang, J. S.-H., Law, Y. W., Zhang, Y., & Yip, P. S. F. (2019). Determinants of Poverty and Their Variation Across the Poverty Spectrum: Evidence from Hong Kong, a High-Income Society with a High Poverty Level. <i>Social Indicators Research</i>, 144(1), 219–250 Rahman, A., Bhattacharjee, A., Nisat, R., & Das, N. (2023). Graduation approach to poverty reduction in the humanitarian context: Evidence from Bangladesh. <i>Journal of International Development</i>, 35(6), 1287–1317 Saunders, P., & Tang, V. M. (2019). Adult and child deprivation in Hong Kong. <i>Social Policy & Administration</i>, 53(6), 820–834 Wong, H., & Chan, S. M. (2019). The impacts of housing factors on deprivation in a world city: The case of Hong Kong. <i>Social Policy & Administration</i>, 53(6), 872–888 Wong, Y. C. (2017). <i>Fixing Inequality in Hong Kong</i>. Hong Kong University Press Yip, P. S. F., Peng, C., Wong, H. K., & So, B. K. (2020). Social Welfare Transfers and Poverty Transitions in Hong Kong: Evidence from Two-Wave Panel Data. <i>Social Indicators Research</i>, 151(3), 841–864 Yip, P. S. F. (2021). <i>Social Unrest and the Poverty Problem in Hong Kong: Growth Imbalance and Sustainable Development</i>. Springer 丁喬, 程詩詠, 雷日昇, & 歐樹林. (2022). <i>疫情・逆情</i>. 香港社區組織協會 史迪格里茲. (2016). <i>不公平的代價: 破解階級對立的金權結構(中譯本)</i>. 台北: 天下雜誌 門倉貴史. (2008). <i>窮忙族: 新貧窮階級時代的來臨</i>. 台北: 聯經 阿特金森. 安東尼. (2015). <i>扭轉貧富不均(中譯本)</i>. 台北: 天下文化
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	李健正等編. (1999). <i>新社會政策</i>. 香港: 香港中文大學出版社 史文鴻, 吳俊雄. (1997). <i>香港貧窮不同面貌研究</i>. 香港: 香港明愛青少年及社區服務 周永新. (2014). <i>真實的貧窮面貌——綜觀香港社會 60 年</i>. 中華書局(香港)有限公司 周永新 (2017). <i>創建公平和關愛社會：香港民生政策的得與失 (初版.)</i>. 中華書局 馮可立. (2018). <i>貧而無怨難：香港民生福利發展史 初版.</i>. 中華書局 黃洪. (2000). <i>香港邊緣勞工近年的發展</i>. 香港: 樂施會 黃洪 (2015). 「無窮」的盼望：香港貧窮問題探析 (增訂版). 中華書局香港有限公司 黃洪等. (2003). <i>不是烏托邦</i>. 香港: 樂施會 謝普勒, K. 大衛. (2018). <i>窮忙：我們這樣的世代(中譯本)</i>. 台灣: 時報版被 羅伯特, 普特南(2016). <i>階級世代：窮小孩與富小孩的機會不平等(中譯本)</i>. 台北: 衛城出版 顧汝德. (2015). <i>富中之貧：香港社會矛盾的根源(中譯本)</i>. 香港: 天窗出版社有限公司 樂施會. (2002). <i>香港邊緣勞工口述史</i>. 香港: 樂施會 樂施會. (2007). <i>綜援 nization</i>. 香港: 樂施會 關注貧窮問題工作小組. (2005). <i>深水土步區貧窮問題及扶窮現況：以‘需要為本’及‘資產為本’的分析</i>. 香港: 深水埗區議會 葉兆輝. (2018). <i>香港貧窮問題真相</i>. 香港: 中華書局有限公司 歐陽達初, 黃和平. (2017). <i>未完成的香港社會保障：批判的導論</i>. 香港: 中華書局 Websites: In-media http://www.inmediahk.net 香港社會服務聯會 http://www.hkcss.org.hk 扶貧委員會 http://www.cop.gov.hk 社會福利署 http://www.swd.gov.hk 香港脫貧網 http://hkpoverty.oxfam.org.hk 關注草根生活聯盟 https://cglahk.wordpress.com 福利事務委員會 http://www.legco.gov.hk/chinese/index.htm
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